



646 CE

TAIKA REFORMS IN JAPAN

The Japanese court had, for half a century, been dominated by the corrupt Soga clan. A coup led by Prince Naka no Ōe and Nakatomi no Kamatari ended Soga influence and a new emperor was installed, his reign referred to as the Taika era. A series of reforms were instituted, based on the model of Tang China. Private ownership of land was abolished, direct control by the emperor over the administration imposed, laws codified, and a fair tax system instituted. These Taika reforms greatly strengthened Japan.

◁ Nakatomi no Kamatari

▷ Silla dynasty
stoneware ossuary

668 CE

UNIFICATION OF KOREA UNDER THE SILLA

In 660 CE, King Munmu of the Korean state of Silla attacked the rival kingdom of Baekje. Within eight years he overcame both Baekje and the third Korean state, Koguryo, expelled Tang Chinese forces, and united Korea for the first time, establishing a government modelled on that of the Tang.

699 CE

672 CE Tikal conquers

Dos Pilas to become the dominant Maya city-state



650 CE

COMPILATION OF THE QURAN

After the death of the Prophet Muhammad in 632 CE, disputes arose about who should succeed him, and the need grew for an agreed text of the Quran, which had previously been transmitted orally. The process of writing down the sacred book was completed under Caliph Uthman around 650 CE, and the earliest surviving manuscripts date shortly after him.

◁ Birmingham Quran manuscript